

NICHOLLS STATE UNIVERSITY

Request for HSIRB Exemption

1. Name(s) of Principal Investigator(s): Dr. Christopher Castille Phone: 985-449-7015

Other Investigators: None

Faculty Sponsor (If Student Research): N/A (faculty PI) Phone: _____

2. College: CBA (Al Danos) Department: Management and Marketing Phone: 985-449-7015

3. Title of Project or Proposal: HR Situational Judgment Test: Evidence-Based HR Decision-Making

4. **Description of Project or Proposal (attach additional information as needed):**

- a. Briefly describe the population of human subjects involved (e.g., University students, community members, athletes, homemakers, school children, etc.) **You MUST indicate if this participation is VOLUNTARY or NOT. Subjects must be 18 or older for HSIRB Exemption.**

Two groups, all 18+: (1) Undergraduates in MNGT 425 (HR Analytics) and related Management & Marketing courses at Nicholls. Course exercise may be required for class; research use of ratings (secondary-data consent) is VOLUNTARY with no grade effect (grade shield). (2) HR professionals recruited via professional networks; participation is VOLUNTARY. Under-18 excluded (required for HSIRB exemption). See Attachment A.

- b. Briefly describe your research procedures and techniques of data collection (e.g., interview, questionnaire, test administration, observation of public behavior, etc.). **You MUST include a printed copy of any data collection instrument(s) as well as active link(s) if online or electronic data collection methods are being utilized.**

Electronic informed consent (professional + class forms). Online HR Situational Judgment Test: 27 HR scenarios; optional 1–5 effectiveness ratings per tactic; Skip allowed (no forced responding). Feedback PDF/debrief. ~45–60 min. Instrument + active links: <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/run/>; consents under /hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/; incidents.json in IRB packet. Printed instrument = Attachment C / full packet. See Attachment A.

- c. Briefly describe the objectives of your research (e.g., what hypotheses you are testing.)

(1) Measure how students rate HR tactic effectiveness in SJT scenarios; (2) measure HR professionals' ratings as an expert benchmark; (3) compare student vs professional ratings; (4) identify most/least effective tactics across HR domains; (5) examine whether evidence-based HR training shifts student ratings toward professional norms (if pre/post used). See Attachment A.

5. a. How will you recruit subjects? **YOU MUST submit VERBATIM COPIES** of all letters, emails, notices, advertisements, etc. and/or all oral presentations to be used to recruit subjects/ participation in the research project (e.g. scripts of direct person-to-person solicitation, telephone solicitation, newspaper solicitation, letters of solicitation, email solicitation, notices of solicitation posted to Facebook or Moodle, etc.).

Students: course/PRAMS announcement for MNGT 425 (+ related courses); secondary-data consent for research use. Professionals: LinkedIn/SHRM/HR networks + professional consent page. Verbatim recruitment script in Attachment A / Appendix D of full packet.

- b. List all criteria for including subjects.

Age 18+; students enrolled in MNGT 425 or related M&M courses at Nicholls; professionals with current/recent HR experience; internet-capable device. See Attachment A.

- c. List all criteria for excluding subjects.

Under 18; unable to complete online assessment; prior participation (duplicates); students not at Nicholls (student arm); no current/recent HR experience (professional arm).

6. Describe subject benefits and costs:

- a. Indicate what, if any, benefits may accrue to each of the following: (Payment to research subjects for participation in studies is considered a benefit.)

1) The human subjects involved:

Feedback reports; learning about evidence-based HR / SJT; contribution to research; optional aggregated infographic (individuals not identified).

2) Individuals who are not subjects, but who may have similar problems:

Educators and HR trainers may use findings to improve HR education and assessment.

3) Society in general:

Improved understanding of HR situational judgment and evidence-based HR education.

- b. State type, amount, method of disbursement, schedule of payment to be offered, and the effect of withdrawal from participation in the study, if any:

No monetary payment. MNGT 425 exercise supplements class time; research secondary-data consent is voluntary with no grade impact. All may receive feedback reports.

- c. Estimated costs to each subject due only to the research participation:

1) Time (i.e., total time commitment for the duration of the project)

Approx. 45–60 minutes (live assessment); class secondary-data consent is read/sign only.

2) Money

None.

3) Is repeated testing required? Explain:

Not required. Optional pre/post training comparison only if later used under this protocol.

7. BASIS OF REQUEST FOR EXEMPTION - One of the following (A-E) must be checked.

- _____ A. The research will be conducted only in established or commonly accepted educational settings (like classrooms) **AND** it involves normal educational practices such as research on regular and special educational instructional strategies, or research on the effectiveness of, or the comparison among, instructional techniques, curricula or classroom management methods.
- _____ B. It will be conducted using only questionnaire or interview survey methods **AND** the subjects are elected or appointed public officials or candidates for public office.
- _____ C. It is limited to the collection and study of existing data, documents, records, pathological or diagnostic specimens which are available to the public.

(Request options for exemption continued on next page)

- ☒ D. It is limited to the collection and study of data obtained using only the following techniques **AND** the data or information obtained will be recorded in such a manner that subjects cannot be *identified, directly or indirectly*, through identifiers linked with the subjects:

Check the applicable technique(s):

- ☒ 1. The data will be obtained through the use of educational tests (cognitive, diagnostic, aptitude, achievement, etc.), or
- ☐ 2. Data will be obtained by observing the public behavior of subjects, or
- ☒ 3. Data will be obtained using survey or interview procedures, or
- ☐ 4. Data will be obtained from existing documents, records, pathological or diagnostic specimens.

- ☐ E. It is limited to the collection and study of data obtained by:

1. Observing the public behavior of the participants, or
2. Using survey or interview procedures, **AND:**

BOTH OF THE FOLLOWING MUST BE CHECKED IF E-2 IS THE BASIS FOR THE REQUESTED EXEMPTION:

- ☐ i) The information collected about the subjects behavior ***does not involve*** sensitive subjects such as illegal or immoral conduct, drug or alcohol use, sexual behavior, mental illness, or other possibly personally embarrassing subjects **AND**,
- ☐ ii) The information collected about subjects, if it became known to outsiders, could not reasonably be expected to place the subject at risk of civil or criminal liability, or be damaging to the subjects social or financial standing or employability.

8. **Attach copies of current CITI Training certificate(s) for all investigators. Faculty Sponsors of student research must provide a copy of their current CITI Training certificate. Please be sure to select (enroll) and complete the appropriate series of modules based on your area / learner group. URL TO CITI TRAINING: <https://about.citiprogram.org/en/homepage/> There are 5 different learner groups for Nicholls State University:**

Faculty Researchers / Faculty Sponsors – If you are conducting research involving human subjects or if you are the faculty sponsor / supervisor of student research which does NOT involve the areas of biomedical research. **NOTE: Nursing and Allied Health Faculty are required to complete the HIPAA module (not suggested as for all other faculty).**

Student Researchers (Not Nursing/Allied Health): Any research being conducted by a student or student group (either thesis, class project, service/experiential learning, or academic oriented research) where human subjects are involved (surveyed, experimental design, and/or observation).

IRB Members: Any member of the HSIRB Committee at Nicholls State University

CITI attached: Christopher Castille — Human Subjects Research / Faculty Researchers and Research Sponsors (Basic). Completion 10-May-2024; Expiration 10-May-2026; Record ID 59381539. Certificate appended to this PDF.

Nursing and Allied Health Students: Modules in this group include the Basic Social-Behavioral-Educational Modules as well as additional required modules, as required by consensus of the Faculty within the respective College and Department.

Biomedical Data or Specimens/Researchers (Faculty and Students): Any Faculty / Students whose Research involves the use or collection of biomedical data and/or specimens.

NOTE: Depending on the exact protocols used. If additional data is collected by means of a survey from subjects, then the researchers (both faculty, faculty sponsors and students) are required to complete additional modules (Faculty – Faculty Researchers/Research Sponsors; Students – Student Researchers (Not Nursing or Allied Health)).

9. STATEMENT OF RISK:

The undersigned certify that they believe that the conduct of the above described research creates no risk of physical or emotional harm, or social or legal embarrassment to any participating human subject.

Dr. Christopher Castille _____ (Sign/date upon submission)
Signature of Principal Investigator Date

10. FACULTY SPONSOR (if a student is the principal investigator)

N/A — Principal Investigator is faculty _____
Signature of Faculty Sponsor Date

11. RECOMMENDATION OF HSIRB REPRESENTATIVE OR HSIRB CHAIR:

I recommend that the above described research project be exempt from review.

Signature of Chairperson Date HSIRB PROTOCOL NUMBER _____
(Assigned by HSIRB)

NOTE – APPROVE HSIRB Research is valid for a 12 month period of time from the date approved. Approved research can be renewed and extended for a 1 year period at the request of the principle investigator / faculty member – PRIOR to the expiration of an existing HSIRB Protocol Number. Projects can be renewed a maximum of two (2) times. Any faculty wishing to continue a research project beyond year 3 must submit a new request. If approved, a new HSIRB Protocol Number will be issued.

The mailing or distribution of surveys or the collection of data may begin ONLY after this form has received committee approval (ALLOW 10 DAYS FOR PROCESSING) and has been properly filed with the HSIRB Representative or HSIRB Chairperson. It must have signatures of the Principal Investigator(s) or Faculty Sponsor. The Committee may, upon review of this application, deny the request for an exemption. To inquire about approval status, please contact the HSIRB Representative you submitted the application to or the HSIRB Chairperson.

ATTACHMENT A — HSIRB Exempt Review Request (rev9 2019)

Project: HR Situational Judgment Test: Evidence-Based HR Decision-Making

PI: Dr. Christopher Castille | Phone: 985-449-7015 | Email: christopher.castille@nicholls.edu

College: Al Danos College of Business Administration | Dept: Management and Marketing

4a. Population of human subjects

Two groups, all 18+: (1) Undergraduates in MNGT 425 (HR Analytics) and related Management & Marketing courses at Nicholls. Course exercise may be required for class; research use of ratings (secondary-data consent) is VOLUNTARY with no grade effect (grade shield). (2) HR professionals recruited via professional networks; participation is VOLUNTARY. Under-18 excluded (required for HSIRB exemption). See Attachment A.

4b. Research procedures and data collection

Electronic informed consent (professional + class forms). Online HR Situational Judgment Test: 27 HR scenarios; optional 1–5 effectiveness ratings per tactic; Skip allowed (no forced responding). Feedback PDF/debrief. ~45–60 min. Instrument + active links: <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/run/>; consents under /hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/; incidents.json in IRB packet. Printed instrument = Attachment C / full packet. See Attachment A.

4c. Objectives of the research

(1) Measure how students rate HR tactic effectiveness in SJT scenarios; (2) measure HR professionals' ratings as an expert benchmark; (3) compare student vs professional ratings; (4) identify most/least effective tactics across HR domains; (5) examine whether evidence-based HR training shifts student ratings toward professional norms (if pre/post used). See Attachment A.

5a. Recruitment (verbatim script)

Study Title: HR Situational Judgment Test: Evidence-Based HR Decision-Making Description: You will complete an online HR Situational Judgment Test with 27 HR management scenarios. For each scenario, you will rate the effectiveness of different HR tactics. You will receive a feedback report. Your responses will be used for research on HR education and decision-making. Duration: Approximately 45–60 minutes Mode: Online (complete at your own pace) Required for MNGT 425; supplements class time. All participants receive feedback reports. Requirements: Must be 18 years of age or older

5b. Inclusion criteria

- Must be at least 18 years of age - For students: Must be currently enrolled in MNGT 425 (HR Analytics) or related Management and Marketing courses at Nicholls State University - For HR professionals: Must have current or recent professional experience in human resources (e.g., HR manager, recruiter, compensation specialist, HR generalist) - Must have access to a computer or device with internet connection - Must be able to complete web-based assessments and download PDF reports

5c. Exclusion criteria

- Under 18 years of age - Unable to complete online assessments due to technical limitations - Previously participated in this study (to avoid duplicate responses) - For students: Not currently enrolled at Nicholls State University - For HR professionals: No current or recent professional experience in human resources

6a–c. Benefits, payment, and costs

Feedback reports; learning about evidence-based HR / SJT; contribution to research; optional aggregated infographic (individuals not identified). | Others: Educators and HR trainers may use findings to improve HR education and assessment. | Society: Improved understanding of HR situational judgment and evidence-based HR education. | Payment: No monetary payment. MNGT 425 exercise supplements class time; research secondary-data consent is voluntary with no grade impact. All may receive feedback reports. | Time: Approx. 45–60 minutes (live assessment); class secondary-data consent is read/sign only. | Money: None. | Repeated testing: Not required. Optional pre/post training comparison only if later used under this protocol.

7. Basis of exemption — Category D (techniques 1 and 3)

This study qualifies for exempt status under Category D (Educational settings, anonymous surveys/interviews) because: 1. The study involves minimal risk to participants (online situational judgment assessment) 2. All data collection is anonymous – students are identified by PRAMS ID numbers; HR professionals by anonymized session IDs 3. The study involves standard educational and business assessment procedures 4. No sensitive topics or vulnerable populations are involved 5. Participants are adults (18+) who can provide informed consent 6. The study does not involve deception, physical procedures, or collection of sensitive information 7. All procedures are standard in educational research settings The study involves only anonymous data collection through online assessments, with no collection of identifying information beyond anonymized identifiers (PRAMS ID numbers for students; session IDs for HR professionals).

8. CITI training

Christopher Castille — Human Subjects Research / Faculty Researchers and Research Sponsors (Basic Course). Completion 10-May-2024; Expiration 10-May-2026; Record ID 59381539. Certificate attached.

9. Statement of risk (supporting narrative)

This study involves minimal risk to participants. The primary potential risks are: 1. Psychological discomfort: Feedback may differ from expectations. However, all feedback is provided in a supportive, educational context with emphasis on learning and growth. 2. Time commitment: Participants invest approximately 45–60 minutes of their time. For students, the exercise supplements class time as a required course component. 3. Privacy concerns: While all data is anonymized, there is a minimal risk of data breach. However, no personally identifying information is collected beyond PRAMS ID numbers. The risks in this study are no greater than those encountered in normal daily activities or routine educational assessments. Mitigation: Risks are mitigated through: 1. Comprehensive debriefing: All participants receive detailed debriefing explaining the study purpose, their performance, and evidence-based HR concepts in a supportive, educational context via ~~Non-identifiable reports~~. 2. Anonymization: All data is collected with PRAMS ID numbers only – no names, email addresses, or other identifying information is collected. 3. Voluntary participation: Participants can withdraw at any time without penalty. Effectiveness ratings are optional; participants may skip any situation and leave ratings blank (no forced responding). 4. Secure data storage: All data is stored securely on password-protected servers with access limited to the research team. 5. Support resources: Participants are provided with resources for

Active links for IRB review

Interactive instrument (skip/optional ratings): <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/run/> | Professional consent: <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/professional-consent/> | Class/student consent: <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/student-data-consent/> | Full branded packet: [materials/pdf/HSIRB_Application_HR_SJT_Rating_Effectiveness_full_packet.pdf](#)



Completion Date 10-May-2024
Expiration Date 10-May-2026
Record ID 59381539

This is to certify that:

Christopher Castille

Has completed the following CITI Program course:

Not valid for renewal of
certification through CME.

Human Subjects Research

(Curriculum Group)

Faculty Researchers and Research Sponsors

(Course Learner Group)

1 - Basic Course

(Stage)

Under requirements set by:

Nicholls State University

CITI

Collaborative Institutional Training Initiative

101 NE 3rd Avenue, Suite 320

Fort Lauderdale, FL 33301 US

www.citiprogram.org

Generated on 09-Mar-2026. Verify at www.citiprogram.org/verify/?wb2a09797-c34f-44ef-9e80-979837ad3e10-59381539